

Bilawal Ali

Cybersecurity Analyst | SOC | Threat Detection | Security Operations

Pakistan • Open to Relocation to UAE / Saudi Arabia / GCC • +92 344 3559788 • khooharobilawalali@gmail.com
linkedin.com/in/bilawal-ali-0b021124 • github.com/Bila-Ali • bila-ali.github.io

Professional Summary

Final-year B.S. Cyber Security student at Mehran University of Engineering & Technology (MUET), graduating December 2026, with hands-on experience in SOC operations, SIEM monitoring, alert triage, threat detection, incident analysis, vulnerability assessment, and digital forensics. Monitored and triaged 1,000+ security events daily across Windows and Linux environments using Wazuh, with additional experience in Splunk and ELK Stack. Developed custom detection rules, investigated authentication anomalies and suspicious activity, configured File Integrity Monitoring and automated response, and mapped events to MITRE ATT&CK. Seeking entry-level SOC Analyst, Cybersecurity Analyst, Security Operations, or IT Security opportunities across the GCC.

Technical Skills

SOC & Security Operations: Security Monitoring, Alert Triage, Threat Detection, Incident Response, IOC Analysis, Threat Hunting, Log Analysis, Digital Forensics, Incident Escalation

SIEM & Monitoring: Wazuh, Splunk, ELK Stack, Kibana, Suricata, File Integrity Monitoring (FIM), Automated Response

Security Tools: Wireshark, Burp Suite, Metasploit, Nmap, Scapy

Cybersecurity: Vulnerability Assessment, Penetration Testing, Web Application Security, Malware Analysis, Phishing Analysis, Security Automation

Frameworks: MITRE ATT&CK, NIST SP 800-61, OWASP Top 10, Cyber Kill Chain

Programming & Systems: Python, Bash, Pandas, Flask, Streamlit, Machine Learning, Explainable AI, Windows, Linux, Kali Linux

Networking: TCP/IP, DNS, HTTP/HTTPS, Network Traffic Analysis, Firewalls

Professional Experience

SOC Analyst Intern

Feb 2026 – May 2026

Cyberster

Remote

- Monitored and triaged 1,000+ security events daily across Windows and Linux environments using Wazuh SIEM.
- Investigated brute-force attacks, authentication anomalies, lateral movement indicators, and unauthorized system changes.
- Developed and deployed 5+ custom Wazuh detection rules to improve alert coverage and threat detection.
- Configured File Integrity Monitoring (FIM) and automated response to detect unauthorized changes and block malicious IP addresses.
- Investigated Indicators of Compromise (IOCs), analyzed security alerts, and prepared structured incident reports for escalation.
- Mapped security events and attack techniques to MITRE ATT&CK to support threat analysis.

Red Team Intern

Jun 2024 – Aug 2024

ITSOLERA Pvt Ltd

Remote

- Conducted authorized Vulnerability Assessment and Penetration Testing (VAPT) across 20+ web applications.
- Identified SQL Injection, Cross-Site Scripting (XSS), CSRF, and broken authentication vulnerabilities.
- Used Burp Suite, Metasploit, Nmap, and other security testing tools to assess application security weaknesses.
- Documented vulnerabilities with reproduction steps, severity assessments, evidence, and remediation recommendations.

Independent Security Researcher

Jan 2024 – Present

Freelance / Part-time

Remote

- Conducted security assessments of public web applications and APIs, focusing on application security and access-control vulnerabilities.
- Developed Python scripts for security testing, vulnerability analysis, and investigation workflows; responsibly disclosed findings with technical documentation and remediation recommendations.

Education

B.S. Cyber Security

Expected Dec 2026

Mehran University of Engineering & Technology (MUET), Jamshoro, Pakistan

CGPA: 3.39 / 4.0

Selected Cybersecurity Projects

AI-Based PDF Malware Detection System

2026

- Developed a Python-based machine learning system for detecting potentially malicious PDF files using static security features and SHAP Explainable AI.

SOC & Threat Simulation Lab

2026

- Built a security monitoring lab integrating Wazuh, Splunk, ELK Stack, Suricata, and pfSense to generate and analyze security telemetry and practice alert investigation.

MailForensics Tool

2026

- Developed a Python and Streamlit DFIR utility for parsing .eml files, extracting Indicators of Compromise, and identifying phishing-related characteristics.

Certifications

Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate • Google IT Support Professional Certificate • Google IT Automation with Python Professional Certificate • Cisco Junior Cybersecurity Analyst • Practical SOC Analyst T1/T2 Preparation Course – Udemy • Intro to Splunk • Cybersecurity Fundamentals Associate – OPSWAT • CEH (PFTP)

Leadership & Achievements

- **1st Place** – QUEST CTF Hackathon, 2026
- **Consolation Prize, Team Lead** – NADRA Bug Bounty Competition, 2026
- **Ranked 29th Nationally** – Ignite CTF National Hackathon
- Completed 150+ PortSwigger Web Security Academy labs and actively practice on Hack The Box and TryHackMe.
- **Cybersecurity Event Lead & Volunteer**, ACCESS~DENIED, MUET Cyber Security Department – contributed to challenge design and organization of the BSCYS CTF Hackathon 2026 and cybersecurity workshops.

Languages

English • Urdu • Sindhi